

Bryn Mawr College
Econ 236: Introduction to International Economics
Spring Semester 2026

Contact Information:

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This syllabus provides a general plan for the course; deviations may be necessary.

Course Objective:

An introduction to international economics through theory, policy issues, and problems. The course surveys international trade and finance and topics in international economics. It investigates why and what a nation trades, the consequences of such trade, the role of trade policy, economic integration, the behavior and effects of exchange rates, and the macroeconomic implications of trade and capital flows.

Prereq. ECON 105 - Introduction to Economics. You must complete Econ 105 before taking this course.

Textbooks:

The textbook for this course is *International Economics* by James Gerber 7th Edition (earlier editions are also fine). Additional readings will be posted on Moodle.

Course Requirements:

The course requirements include homework assignments and three exams. Homework will be submitted on Moodle or in-class and must be professionally presented for full credit. These questions will be similar to the problems we solve in class and be good practice for exams. Exams 1 and 2 will be **in class**. Final exam is going to be scheduled during the final exam period. Please don't make travel plans till you know the date for the final exam.

Component	Date	Share in total grade
Exam 1	February 26, 2026	25%
Exam 2	April 2, 2026	25%
Final exam	Scheduled Final Exam	25%
Homework		20%
Class participation		5%

A numeric grade of 4.0, 3.7, 3.3, 3.0, 2.7, 2.3, and 2.0 will be assigned to you on the basis of your cumulative score.

4.0: 95%-100% 3.7: 90%-94% 3.3: 87%-89% 3.0: 83%-86% 2.7: 80%-82% 2.3: 77%-79%
2.0: below 76%.

Homework

Homework will be due no less than one week after they are assigned. You must turn in your own work, but group effort is permitted and encouraged. Homework turned in late after the due date will be docked 10 percentage points every 24 hours. After 5 days late, the maximum possible grade will be 50% of the full points.

Disability Support Services: Reasonable Accommodations

Bryn Mawr College is committed to providing equal access to students with a documented disability. Students needing academic accommodations for a disability must first register with Access Services. Students can call 610-526-7516 to make an appointment with the Director of Access Services, Deb Alder, or email her at dalder@brynmawr.edu to begin this confidential process. Once registered, students should schedule an appointment with the professor as early in the semester as possible to share the verification form and make appropriate arrangements. Please note that accommodations are not retroactive and require advance notice to implement. More information can be obtained at the Access Services website. (<http://www.brynmawr.edu/access-services/>)

Any student who has a disability-related need to record this class first must speak with the Director of Access Services and to me, the instructor. Class members need to be aware that this class may be recorded.

Academic Honesty

I expect that all students' behavior in this course will be in accordance with the Bryn Mawr Honor Code, of which you are well aware.

Title IX:

Bryn Mawr/Haverford College is committed to fostering a safe and inclusive living and learning environment where all can feel secure and free from harassment. All forms of sexual misconduct, including sexual assault, sexual harassment, stalking, domestic violence, and dating violence are violations of Bryn Mawr/Haverford's policies, whether they occur on or off campus. Bryn Mawr/Haverford faculty are committed to helping to create a safe learning environment for all students and for the College community as a whole. If you have experienced any form of gender or sex-based discrimination, harassment, or violence, know that help and support are available. Staff members are trained to support students in navigating campus life, accessing health and counseling services, providing academic and housing accommodations, and more.

The College strongly encourages all students to report any incidents of sexual misconduct. Please be aware that all Bryn Mawr/Haverford employees (other than those designated as confidential resources such as counselors, clergy, and healthcare providers) are required to report information about such discrimination and harassment to the [Bi-College Title IX Coordinator](#).

Information about the College's Sexual Misconduct policy, reporting options, and a list of campus and local resources can be found on the College's website:

[Bryn Mawr Sexual Misconduct Policy](#)
[Haverford Sexual Misconduct Policy](#)

Tentative Course Outline:

Date	Topics	Chapter
January 20, 2026	Introduction	1
January 22, 2026	Institutions and Review - EC105	2
January 27, 2026	Comparative Advantage - Ricardo	3
January 29, 2026	Comparative Advantage - Ricardo	3
February 3, 2026	Comparative Advantage - HO Model	4
February 5, 2026	Comparative Advantage - HO Model	4
February 10, 2026	Beyond Comparative Advantage	5
February 12, 2026	Trade Policy	6,7
February 17, 2026	Trade Policy	6,7
February 19, 2026	Trade Policy	6,7
February 19, 2026	International Trade and Labor and Environment Standards	8
February 24, 2026	Exam Review	
February 26, 2026	Exam 1	
March 3, 2026	Trade and Balance of Payments	9
March 5, 2026	Exchange Rate and Exchange Rate Systems	10
March 10, 2026	<i>Spring Break</i>	
March 12, 2026	<i>Spring Break</i>	
March 17, 2026	Introduction to Open Economy Macroeconomics	11
March 19, 2026	Introduction to Open Economy Macroeconomics	11
March 24, 2026	International Financial Crisis	12
March 26, 2026	International Financial Crisis	12
March 31, 2026	Exam Review	
April 2, 2026	Exam 2	
April 7, 2026	International Trade and Labor and Environmental Standards	8
April 9, 2026	Colonialism, Trade and Development	
April 14, 2026	The US in the world economy	13
April 16, 2026	The European Union: Many markets into one	14
April 21, 2026	Trade and Policy Reform in Latin America	15
April 23, 2026	Export-Oriented Growth in East Asia	16
April 28, 2026	India and China	17
April 30, 2026	Exam Review	